



1982

Flawed beauty For her Autumn/Winter 1982 collection for Comme des Garçons, Kawakubo presented this black knitwear that looked moth-eaten – her idea of modern lace. All-black was typical of Kawakubo's 1980s designs.



1984

Deconstructed workwear By restricting the colour palette in her early collections to black and neutrals, Kawakubo focused the eye on construction and shape. This design features an unstructured jacket with distorted lapels.



Colour clash In contrast to the sombre, minimal approaches of Rei Kawakubo and Yohji Yamamoto, Kenzo injected a blast of colour and pattern into his collections. His ready-to-wear shows were inspired by the ethnic patterns of Africa, India, and Asia. One of his signatures was clashing floral prints.



1999

Poetry in motion Yohji Yamamoto has always taken a dark, romantic view of fashion, finding beauty in flaws and mistakes. He prefers working in black, to show off the proportion and volume of his designs. His Spring 1999 collection had a wedding theme.



2008

Culture clash Kawakubo's free-wheeling creative approach is clear in this outfit from her Spring 2008 collection, which is a mashup of clown costume, circus-girl frills, tribal prints, and men's tailoring.



2019

Romantic rock chic After training under Rei Kawakubo at Comme des Garçons, Junya Watanabe began designing for his own label. He is often influenced by streetwear, taking items such as jeans, and deconstructing and reconstructing them – in this case into a 19th-century crinoline.